

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 39

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (25 min)

I – OPENING (5 min)

-KF Meeting Opening

II - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

III - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

IV - KF MEETING "REVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

"Search me, O God, and know my heart. Try me and know my anxious thoughts. See if there is any hurtful way in me, and lead me in everlasting ways." (Psalm 139:23-24, NASB)

OPENING

We have a single purpose at Karis Fellowships: to support one another as we reorient to God and to our true glory. We are Christians who recognize our misorientation, that we have exchanged the truth for the lie of our Idol Self and pursued pride rather than love. We believe that only from our True Self, the self that God created, can we love authentically and become the people God created us to be. We learn to respond to the gift of our real salvation in Jesus Christ by offering our true life to God as a gift, which is holy and acceptable to Him. Every week we come together to ground ourselves in reality, to help us put to death our false strivings and learn to apply real effort to our real growth as we pursue God's will and our true glory.

BIBLE TEACHING

Let's turn again to Romans, chapter 6. Last week we learned that we are in an immersion course, training to live in the new country of karis. Paul says that the people who live in this new country are no longer afraid of death because their Leader, Jesus, has already conquered death.

In the text for this lesson, Paul tells us that we were designed to serve. We cannot help but serve someone. If we abandon one master, we must find another. In our misorientation, we abandoned God and found another master in our Idol Self. We agreed to serve its illusions and compulsive needs and we constructed a way of living that perpetuated the illusion that we can cast off all limitations, do exactly what we please, and still be entitled to excellent outcomes. If we observe our behavior, however, we find that no matter how many virtue stories we tell ourselves about our lives, we are not free. We are compelled by unrecognized inner forces that generate a roller-coaster ride of euphoria and self-hate. Paul is encouraging us to choose the slavery that we were designed for. We were designed to serve God.

This is Nancy's paraphrase of **Romans 6:12-18**:

¹²Therefore, refuse the rule of misorientation in your body—a rule that tyrannizes you into heeding the Idol's compulsive need to save its life. Your body, as well as the Idol system, is going to die anyway, so there is no point in losing your true life to save it. ¹³Furthermore, don't allow your physical body to become a weapon in the service of misorientation, assisting the Idol Self to generate more misorientation. Instead use your physical body as a weapon of orientation for God, assisting Him and His purposes as those who have gone beyond death and fear, and are fully alive. ¹⁴In other words, misorientation shall not be your master. Let me explain. You are not living under a legal system, trying to please a misoriented despot. You are living in karis relationship with God and have access to all of its privileges. ¹⁵So now what? Do we continue to choose misorientation because there is no law or despotic master to punish us? Absolutely not! ¹⁶Perhaps you have not yet figured out that you will be a slave, whether assisting God or the Idol Self. You are the slave of the one that you listen to and obey. It is your choice to either obey misorientation, which produces death, or to obey God, which orients you and the Creation. ¹⁷But thank God, you who used to be the slaves of misorientation heeded from your hearts the pattern of instruction that was entrusted to you. ¹⁸You were willingly liberated from misorientation and enslaved to orientation.

Take a deep breath.

Paul is letting you know that your slavery is not optional, but your choice of master is. Successful service requires training. Your mission is before you. You are designed to become a weapon of orientation, and Jesus must train you for that potential. Unfortunately, you first have to sacrifice the hope of the *Glory of Me!* Then Jesus can show you that serving Him in your True Self is well worth your sacrifice. You will only learn the value of His way of doing things if you submit like a slave to His training. It's not enough to just read the **Toolbox** and Bible teachings and learn about meditation techniques. You have to offer the karis gift of your willingness and your efforts to be trained.

This is our prayer of commitment:

O Captain, my Captain, make me a weapon of orientation in this world. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank You for drawing us together for healing and training. Hold us in the power of this new direction as You continue to guide us to our glory. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to develop our abilities as weapons of orientation, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.